

POSITIVITY AND NEGATIVITY: ONE ENERGY CURRENT

Greetings, my dearest friends. May the blessings of Creative Intelligence, existing all around and within you, strengthen and enlighten you so that these words will find an echo and will serve as material to successfully continue your path toward finding your real self.

These lectures are always directed and addressed to the majority of my friends working on this path. Those of you who have not quite reached the point where you can apply the topic under discussion will nevertheless find it useful and will be helped indirectly to reach this point a little sooner than you otherwise might. When you hear these lectures and cannot immediately apply or even understand them, do not feel discouraged. Know that your path will bring you to the exact position that I am discussing here.

Most of my friends have now found a layer within themselves where they are face to face with their destructiveness. Many of you have come to this awareness. And I mean more than the discovery of a mere emotion, the acknowledgment of a momentary hostility, for instance. I mean an overall, pervasive, essential, lingering destructiveness that has been dormant all along and merely covered up. It is quite a different experience to ascertain this layer, to feel it and the condition you were in before this happened. You are now in a state in which you can observe yourself thinking, feeling, and acting destructively, while, before, you were at best only theoretically aware of it and could merely surmise its presence by the unpleasant manifestations in your life. Now you are coping with the problem of how to get out of this condition. You are puzzled because you do not like it. You even know and comprehend quite profoundly that it is totally useless, senseless, that destructiveness does not fulfill one good purpose. Nevertheless, you find yourself in the situation of being unable to let go of this destructiveness. In order to be able to do so, it is necessary that you understand the nature of destructiveness much better than you do. This will be the main topic of tonight's lecture. It is not easy to get an awareness where you can see yourself think, feel, and act destructively, where you are further aware of the fact that this causes you misery, but you are totally unable and unwilling to give up this way of being. I might say that it is a great measure of success, if this word can be used, to be aware. But to accomplish the second part of this particular phase of your evolution, the nature of destructiveness must be better understood. As usual, this necessitates some repetitions, without which the topic could not be comprehensive.

The whole problem of a dualistic concept of life has a great deal to do with the lack of comprehension of the destructiveness in man. Mankind is geared to think of a destructive force as opposed to a constructive force. Even those of you who theoretically know quite well that there is no such division tend to think: "Here are my negative feelings. I wish I could have positive feelings instead." Or you think that after the negative emotions are dissipated, a new set of feelings will follow, as though this new set of feelings consisted of an entirely different energy or psychic material. When man speaks of the two forces, the two sets of feelings, it is a figure of speech, a way

of expressing two different kinds of experiences. However, this figure of speech is expressive of the dualistic misconception operative within man's consciousness.

Actually, there is only one power. This is very important to understand, my friends, particularly when you come to deal with your own destructiveness, your negativity. There is one life force which energizes every expression of life. The same life force can flow in a constructive, positive, affirming way, or it can turn into a destructive, negating current. In order to understand this process in a specific and personal way, I will discuss it from the point of view of man in relation to his life. I will not give a discourse on general, spiritual principles here, but only touch upon them when it is necessary to understand the whole of the topic.

First, I will repeat that the life force, as such, when untampered with, is totally constructive, totally good, totally positive and affirming. Therefore it produces total pleasure for any living being perceiving consciousness. The more fully this consciousness is developed, the fuller the pleasure it can experience from and through the pure life force, in whatever way this may find expression. The pure life force cannot be anything but beauty.

Every life organism tends to realize this potentiality in nature -- a newborn baby, a plant, a cell. When this natural flow is interfered with, the energy current, seeking expression, is blocked and prohibited from flowing to its destiny. The natural flow is being stopped by conditions. These may be outer or inner conditions, or both. When the young child encounters in the outer environment the conditions that prohibit the natural flow, the extent of the damage depends upon how free he is from inner blockages. If inner blockages exist and lie dormant because they have not been eliminated in previous existences, the outer negative conditions will create a severe blockage, freezing the floating energy current and petrifying it into a hardened psychic mass. When no previous blockages exist, the outer negative conditions will create only a temporary disturbance in the flow of the life force. Man's persistent problems in life are a result of such blocked energy. The unblocking can occur only when the relationship between the inner and the outer negative conditions responsible are thoroughly understood. The child's immature ego faculties make an adequate dealing with the negative condition impossible. The outer negative condition can therefore never be totally responsible for the condensation of energy, for the paralysis of the life stream. It can only be the final activating factor, bringing the dormant negative inner condition to the fore.

Where the outer negative conditions activate the dormant inner negative condition is the point at which the positive life force turns into a destructive nonlife force. Feelings turn from love to fear and hostility, from trust to distrust, and so on. And finally, as you know from the last lecture, the negative power becomes so unbearable that it is numbed altogether.

When a human being finds himself on such a path, it is very important to understand specifically that the negative emotion cannot be replaced by a different positive emotion. It must be reconverted to its original state. How do we go about this, my friends? Each individual must find the way to reconvert this energy flow into its original state. Each life manifestation you are going through that is unpleasant, unpleasurable, problematic, anxiety-producing, is the result of a repetition -- where originally in this life, the positive pleasure force has been blocked, hindered, prohibited and has therefore turned into unpleasure.

Now, in this unpleasure it cannot be stated accurately that pleasure is totally absent. In a different context, I mentioned this before, but it is not sufficiently understood, so I have come back to it and discuss it from a new angle. When you find yourself stymied in your attempt to overcome negativity, it is extremely important to sense deep within yourself the pleasurable aspect involved in this negativity, regardless of how much pain exists in your surface consciousness. The difficulty of ridding yourself of destructiveness is of course due also to other reasons which you have already verified -- the desire to punish or the forcing current that negativity and destructiveness often are. The idea is: "If I am sufficiently unhappy, I will prove how wrong the world is not to give me what I want." But these reasons are not the deepest difficulty in shedding negativity. It is necessary to sense, first intuitively, then to feel very specifically, that a dichotomy between pleasure and unpleasure exists, at the same time, regarding your negativity.

This is very understandable when you look at the process in terms of the explanation I gave. The pleasure principle cannot possibly be completely absent in its distortion. Its basic ingredients must always remain, no matter how far gone the distortion is and, consequently, how difficult it is to detect the original nature of the life current. This is precisely why negativity seems so difficult to shed. There always exists the pleasurable aspect of it. When it is understood that only the form of expression must be changed so that the identical life current reconverts itself, negativity can be shed. When it is understood that the painful aspects of it can be abandoned, while the pleasurable aspects will increase, negativity can transform itself. When it is understood that not a new set of emotions will come from out of nowhere, but that the same current manifests differently, what seems hard will happen by itself. When you thus meditate, it will become possible for you to be aware of the pleasure attached to your destructiveness. Instead of feeling guilty about this pleasure and consequently repressing it, you will be in a position to allow the current to unfold, express itself, and reconvert itself. The very attachment of or connection between pleasure and destructiveness has been instrumental in the widespread guilt feeling mankind has about all experiences of pleasure. This, in turn, is responsible for numbing all feelings, for how can the pleasure be liberated from the destructiveness if both are considered equally wrong? And yet, in secret, man cannot live without pleasure, for life and pleasure are one and the same. When pleasure is linked to destructiveness, destructiveness cannot be given up. It is as if life were given up. This brings about a situation where, on one level of his inner life, man holds on equally to pleasure and destructiveness, feeling guilty and afraid regarding both. On a more conscious level, he is numbed and feels little or nothing.

It is not sufficient to know this generally. It must be brought back to your specific circumstances. What is the outer manifestation at this moment that causes you continuous anguish, not a momentary experience caused by a one time condition that then dissolves when new conditions arise, but rather the problems in your life that you cannot come to terms with? In order truly to resolve these conditions (which we call images and which recreate forever new and similar conditions), the blocked and paralyzed energy must be made fluid again. And this can only happen when you begin, as the first step in this particular phase of your development, to ascertain the pleasurable aspect in your destructiveness. You must feel the pleasure attached to the unpleasure of the problem. This must be a distinct realization.

Since the pleasure current in the life force primarily manifests itself in man's life as what is referred to as "sexuality," destructive, blocked energy contains blocked sexual energy. It follows that outer problems must be symbolic or representative of how sexual energy was first stopped by outer

conditions. The pain of this stoppage has caused destructiveness which at the same time contains aspects of the pleasure principle. Therefore every difficult situation in life represents a sexual fixation in the innermost psyche that man fears and runs away from. Because he does not face up to this and live it, the outer conditions become unresolvable. It becomes more and more alienated from its inner cause where it is still enlivened by the pleasure aspect.

You on this path must therefore go back in, as it were, and permit yourself to feel the pleasure in the destructiveness. Then and only then will you truly comprehend the painful outer situation which, offhand, may have nothing to do with your emotional life or with any sexual problems. I have often mentioned that in man's most secret sexual fantasies lie the secrets of his conflicts, as well as the key to their resolution. When you find the parallel between the outer problem and the pleasure current in your sexuality, you will be able to make the frozen energy fluid again. This will enable you to dissolve the negativity, the destructiveness, and this, of course, is essential for the elimination of the outer problem.

The inability to feel the pleasure in the unpleasure is the result of your fighting against yourself and not liking yourself for this particular distortion. Consequently, there is denial, repression, and further alienation from the nucleus, where these conditions can be experienced and gradually altered.

Every problem must have such a nucleus where the original current has been blocked and is therefore distorted and where the pleasure/unpleasure dichotomy produces an unconscious fixation of the pleasure principle. This is then fought against for any number of reasons, with the further consequence that the outer problems begin to form, repeat, and repeat. They cannot be overcome until this nucleus is experienced. This applies to all stubborn problems whether or not they seem to have anything to do with sexuality.

Now, my friends, this chain reaction, as I just explained, must be personally understood and worked through. You must stop running away from this distortion in yourself. You must allow yourself to see it, to let it unfold itself within you, live it through within yourself. And then you will see the dichotomy between pleasure and unpleasure. You will understand and experience why and how destructiveness, in whatever shape or form it is manifest in your life, seems so difficult to abandon. At the same time, it will loosen up far more than ever before when you tried to force it away without this understanding.

All this may sound very theoretical for the person who is still distant from this point, but many of my friends are very near or are already at the point where these words can be used and put into action, into recognition. This will be such a turning point in your inner and consequently your outer life that it will no longer be a problem to abandon destructiveness. For one cannot succeed by forcing with the surface will, without a deep comprehension of the forces within that are components of this very destructiveness. Yes, the will must of course be there in principle, but at the same time, as I have said in so many other contexts, the outer will should only be used for the purpose of liberating the inner powers that make the development a natural, organic, harmonious process. Thus destructiveness dissolves itself. It is not deliberately dropped, like a cloak, nor are constructive feelings produced by a similar act of will. It is an evolutionary process within yourself, right here and now.

Another area where man finds himself extremely blocked, hindered, and impatient with his own evolution or development is in connection with envy. This is a much more important topic than most of you realize. Here again, a number of my friends have begun to see that wherever their life is problematic, envy exists. Wherever there is no problem, they are free from it. Again, this envy gives rise to self-hatred and to running away from that point within this envy which has to be transcended in order really and truly to come out of the envy current and reconvert it into its original nature.

What causes envy is again the dualistic concept, which expresses life in terms of either/or. "Either I have, or the other has" is the nature of all envy. This implies the limitation in which man experiences the universe. The universe is infinite in its abundance and really knowing this makes envy impossible. For what the other person has is not taken away from you. What you have was never taken away from another. The misconception presents innumerable problems. It not only creates envy, but also guilt. It paralyzes the relaxed powerful flow of reaching toward the good that can be yours. It makes you very hesitant to express and experience the best that is possible. It makes you see problems in a distorted fashion. It produces guilt for wanting and, at the same time, an envy of what others have.

This distorted perception of conditions in life is also responsible for an overall competitive attitude that afflicts mankind. This is manifest particularly strongly in some civilizations at certain periods of their history. Understanding the truth of the matter makes it impossible for one person to measure himself against another person. Comparison between two people is totally unrealistic; it measures two factors that cannot be measured. A specific strain is removed from the person who is no longer caught in this error. When you comprehend the uniting principle, that good is never divisible, a number of problems are eliminated. You will not be envious, and therefore you will not feel guilty. Nor will you be faced with the apparent necessity of renouncing in favor of someone else because you will know deeply that what is yours is yours and what is the other person's is his. That very fact will make the selfishness and dishonesty existing in the childish nature, where the tendency to cheat life always prevails, impossible. You will not have to try to get away with anything. Nor will you have to be special in terms of comparing yourself with others once you really comprehend the principle.

In the last question-and-answer session, we discussed this topic in connection with a question about the harm of desire or need to be special. In connection with the topic of this lecture, I say that this need is due to confusing the rightful tendency toward and the inner need to bring about full self-realization. What is the confusion here? Full self-realization always enhances the uniqueness of the individual. It does not level off individuality, nor does it imply mediocrity in the least -- quite the contrary. Why, then, is it believed that not needing to be special means no individuality or even mediocrity? The answer is this. When the need to be special contains a desire to triumph over others, it signifies an attitude of being against others. It implies that self-enhancement can only exist at the expense of others. This is the either/or resulting from the erroneous concept of duality, which cannot help being destructive. It actually does destroy the other's value, at least in desire and aim, if not in actual fact. The further consequence is that the deep-seated, self-regulating process of conscience says no to this endeavor and stops the outgoing energy current. This current then becomes either negative or numbed. This means that man is either passive, paralyzed, and holds back, or he is ruthless, with the inevitable guilt and outer consequences.

The truth of the matter and the solution to this confusion can only be found when you distinguish between two totally different ways of measuring or of evaluating, or let us even say, two totally different goals. When you want to be special in order to triumph over others, when your uniqueness exists at the expense of others and measures itself by others, this uniqueness is destructive and must lead to innumerable problems. But when you realize that your own specialness, without measuring yourself with others, can be unlocked, you will have no problem whatsoever. You will be free to unblock and unfold the best in yourself without infringing upon other people's rights or needs. Quite the contrary, your best will contribute to others rather than take away from them, and you will express this best without the need to cheat, to get by, to get more than you give. The freedom of the power will activate more power. There will be no need to put the brakes on. Envy, guilt, dishonesty, and the belittlement of others create the need to put the brakes on one's most constructive outgoing power current. When man is ignorant of the fact that he has within himself the possibilities for self-fulfillment, the only way he can conceive of expressing himself is by measuring and comparing himself with others. When he knows that, regardless of whether he is better or worse than others, he has his own quota to fulfill toward himself, he will not have any conflict about this subject. Of course, you should express your best, but if, in any way, no matter how secretly, your best is designed to lord it over others or to get away with special unfair privileges, to obtain something for nothing, you will get yourself into trouble. Then individuality cannot unfold because ego, vanity, and ruthlessness take its place. That automatically hinders the positive power at work and converts it into a destructive power.

When you feel envy or, the other side of the same coin, the need to impress others or be better than they, try to feel the constructive power behind this need. For this need is only a distortion of the inborn urge to realize the best in you. When you do this, you will no longer find yourself blocked and paralyzed.

Are there any questions?

QUESTION: What makes the perception of pleasure so unique and specific in relation to the unpleasure?

ANSWER: This is a very important question, and the answer may not seem to be a direct one, but it is. It is known that man fears pleasure when he is still full of conflicts and problems whose nature he does not understand. Anyone on this path who goes deeply enough to probe his reactions discovers this startling fact -- he is more afraid of pleasure than of pain. He who has not verified this fact in himself may find this unbelievable, for he consciously resents the unpleasure and wishes it away. And to a degree, this is true, for the unpleasure cannot be really wanted. Man cannot rid himself of this dichotomy when he does not go deep enough to feel the pleasure in the unpleasure within his psychic processes. Total pleasure is feared for a very important reason. The pleasure supreme of the cosmic energy current must seem unbearable, too much, frightening, almost annihilating when the personality is still geared to negativity and destructiveness. To put it differently, to the degree that the personality has impaired his integrity, to the degree that impurity, dishonesty, cheating, and malice exist in the psyche, pure pleasure must be rejected so that the pain of the negative pleasure principle is the only way the entity can experience a modicum of pleasure at all. When you on your path find that deep within yourself you fear pleasure as a danger, you must ask yourself: "Where am I not honest with life, with myself? Where do I cheat? Where do I impair my integrity?" This is precisely where, why, and to what degree pure pleasure must be rejected. It

further explains why destructiveness is held when man ascertains in himself that he fears and rejects pleasure. Rather than being deprived of it by life, he can do something by asking himself the pertinent questions and subsequently finding the elements of impairment in himself. This is the way out. When he finds where he violates his sense of decency and honesty, he can unlock the door which keeps him on a negative pleasure principle and which forces him to reject the pleasure that is unhampered by pain.

QUESTION: Would you define pleasure as expansion and pain as contraction?

ANSWER: Yes, that is quite true. Pain is a contraction in the sense of a cramp. But there is also contraction in pure pleasure -- only in a rhythmic smooth motion, in a harmonious way. Unpleasure is an extended, protracted contraction, in a cramplike fashion.

QUESTION: The way I experience fear of pleasure is by experiencing a fear of losing myself in pleasure. Is that what you meant?

ANSWER: Yes, this is precisely what I meant. This can be explained when you think about it in terms of trust. When you, consciously or unconsciously, sense deeply your hidden little mechanisms of not being straightforward with the life process, when your response to life is negative in any form and consequently your sense of integrity is impaired, you cannot trust yourself. Nor can you trust yourself when you run away from the nucleus of your negative pleasure principle, as explained in this lecture. It has to be accepted -- understood and inwardly lived through in full self-acceptance before you can trust yourself to be unguarded. As I often said, your innermost self, your own psychic energies, and the life energies are of one and the same substance. You cannot trust yourself without trusting life. You cannot distrust yourself. If you distrust yourself for any reason, right or wrong, how can you lose yourself into yourself and into life? A trust must exist, and this trust is in principle absolutely justifiable. But in practice, in specific manifestations, it is often not justifiable. Full self-acceptance must be established before trust can exist. Then there will no longer be any fear of losing yourself because it will be experienced as bringing you back to yourself richer than ever.

QUESTION: Is the principle of pain and pleasure characteristic of this earth sphere?

ANSWER: It is characteristic of this earth sphere, but this does not merely mean incarnated beings. It means all those who are in this specific state of consciousness whether they are in the flesh or out of the body. It applies to all those whose consciousness is geared to the concept of dualism, who cannot perceive the conciliating, unifying way of creation, of life, of themselves. In all these cases, pleasure and pain must exist as opposites. As I said at the beginning of this lecture, the good and the bad forces, pleasure and pain, are thought two separate forces, not one and the same energy current.

QUESTION: It seems to me that when I do something I don't like, which is meant to invite anger or guilt or jealousy, that I have someone else whom I hold responsible for my being the way I am. Is this a valid observation, and what should I do about it?

ANSWER: Even if some of the blame is put on the other person's doorstep as a partially true situation -- and this is usually the case with sane human beings -- there must be something in you

that you ignore and which bothers you, for otherwise there could be no problem, no disharmonious feeling in you. It would be relatively easy to accept the other person's shortcomings or failings. Otherwise, one would not be involved in situations where these failings cannot help but negatively affect the self. Therefore the very fact of such disturbances points to unknown elements which must be ascertained in order to eliminate destructive feelings. Hence, this anger is essentially directed against the self. You may be angry because you are angry and you cannot accept this emotion in yourself. You may become angry because you cannot accept a similar or corresponding aspect in yourself. That is, that which angers you in the other may exist in a slightly different form in yourself. In short, the question must be asked: "What is it in me that has produced this situation? How am I a coproducer of this situation? In what way do I contribute to it?"

Again, the dualistic concept of life hinders and confuses. If one attempts to solve such a problem in an attitude of finding either the one or other person at fault, no solution exists. Neither of these two alternatives satisfies, for it must be off the mark or superficial in evaluation. True enlightenment can only come when the unconscious interaction, how one inner problem affects the other person's inner problem, is seen as interacting vicious circles. When you truly realize that the situation must be a coproduction, then you can begin to make serious headway in the right direction.

The second thing I have to say here is this. Often a person cannot find the answer because he looks for the cause in a limited or moralistic way. The way he may contribute to the situation may be altogether different from the one he feels defensive about. For example, a person tries to exonerate himself because he senses a badness in himself. Actually his contribution may not be anything bad or mean at all. It may be rather that he underestimates his values, his rights, his entire person. He may be weak, submissive, not assertive enough and thus encourages a negative situation in a very different way from that which he vaguely defends against in himself. Such weakness is of course always a result of some disturbance of the psyche on a deep level and cannot help but create negativity and destructiveness, but the way to eliminate it is not by forcing the destructive feelings away. This cannot succeed. One must work on a very deep level with these problems. Often weakness is confused with goodness, and strength with ruthlessness or selfishness. In these confusions, man does not find the way to resolve the problem and find clarity.

Therefore I suggest a meditation that reaches deep into the self and says: "I do want to see where I possibly violate some spiritual law, where I am wrong in the usual sense of the word, but I would also like to know where I am weak and confused and, because of it, negative emotions come into existence. Where is it that I am perhaps not aware of my values and, because of this lack of awareness, I fight in the wrong way? I would like to see these elements and straighten them out. I want to see both these aspects." And, usually, they interact; they are not unconnected elements. Lack of self-assertion on one level may induce an angry overassertion on the surface. When the meditation is directed into such channels, new vision may come -- vision that was hitherto blocked.

May your understanding grow so that you sense your own distortions and how these distortions are a valuable life energy that can be activated in the specific way I showed here.

Be blessed every one of you, receive the strength and the power that flows into you. Make use of it, travel this path to the very nucleus of your own inner being. Be in God!

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